

— PHASE II · INFRASTRUCTURE PLANNING & MANAGEMENT — A .LLAB™ WORKBOOK

Leadership Alignment Map™

Connect mission, vision, values, strategy, and culture — and find exactly where they stop lining up.

PHASE

II · Infrastructure Planning & Management

INVESTMENT

\$50

Most organizations aren't **misaligned** on purpose.

They wrote a mission statement once. They set a strategy separately, usually under deadline pressure. Values got chosen in a workshop nobody fully remembers. Culture built itself, day by day, out of whoever was in the room. None of it was designed to connect — so it doesn't, and everyone quietly compensates for the gap.

What "alignment" actually means here

Alignment isn't a values poster and a strategy deck agreeing with each other on paper. It's a working test: when someone makes a real decision under pressure, do mission, vision, values, strategy, and culture point the same direction — or does the person have to quietly pick which one to honor and which to ignore?

Every time that choice gets made silently, it teaches the organization which layer actually governs behavior. Usually it isn't the one on the wall.

THE CORE IDEA

Leadership Infrastructure™ isn't five separate documents. It's one connected system. This workbook maps the five layers, tests where they disagree with each other in practice, and gives you a concrete next move for the gap that matters most.

How to use this workbook

Budget 45–60 minutes. You'll get the most out of this if you bring your organization's actual mission statement, stated values, and current strategic priorities — not your memory of them. The Map works from what's written and what's real, and the distance between the two is often the most useful finding in the whole exercise.

The **five layers**.

Each layer answers a different question. Leadership is the connective layer — it's the only one that touches all four of the others, every day, in how decisions actually get made.

LAYER	THE QUESTION IT ANSWERS
Mission	Why does this organization exist, beyond making money?
Vision	What does success look like, years from now, if this works?
Values	What do we refuse to compromise on, even when it's costly?
Strategy	What are we actually doing this year to move toward the vision?
Culture	What do people actually do when no one senior is watching?

Where alignment breaks

1 Strategy contradicts Values

The plan asks people to do something the stated values would forbid — cut a corner, deprioritize a stakeholder, chase a metric the values claim not to chase. When this happens, values quietly lose; they always do, under deadline.

2 Culture contradicts Strategy

The plan requires speed; the culture rewards consensus. The plan requires risk; the culture punishes visible failure. Strategy written without accounting for the culture that has to execute it is a plan for friction, not results.

3 Vision has no path back to Mission

The vision describes a destination that, if you're honest, has nothing to do with why the organization exists. Growth for its own sake, disconnected from purpose, is the fastest way to build something people stop believing in.

Map the **gaps.**

Write each layer in one honest sentence — not the polished version, the real one. Then test each pair below for contradiction.

MISSION (WHY WE EXIST)

VISION (WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE)

VALUES (NON-NEGOTIABLE, EVEN COSTLY)

STRATEGY (WHAT WE'RE ACTUALLY DOING THIS YEAR)

CULTURE (WHAT PEOPLE ACTUALLY DO WHEN NO ONE SENIOR IS WATCHING)

The contradiction test

PAIR	WHERE THEY DISAGREE IN PRACTICE
Strategy vs. Values	
Culture vs. Strategy	
Vision vs. Mission	

Fix the **one gap** that costs the most.

You will not close every gap this quarter. Rank them and take the first one seriously.

- **Circle the contradiction with the widest gap** — the one where the written layer and the lived layer point in genuinely different directions, not just different emphasis.
- **Name who feels this gap first.** It's rarely leadership. It's usually the newest hire, the frontline team, or the customer — the people with the least power to quietly work around it.
- **Decide which layer moves.** Sometimes the fix is changing the strategy to honor the values. Sometimes the values were aspirational and the honest move is rewriting them. Both are legitimate — pretending there's no gap isn't.

Alignment isn't agreement on paper. It's what happens when someone has to choose, under pressure, and every layer points the same way.

Where this fits

The Alignment Map is Phase II — Infrastructure Planning & Management: once you know what you're aligning, the next move is turning the highest-priority gap into a concrete 30-day build with the **Leadership Infrastructure Build Plan™**, or — if the gap is really about your own leadership identity and influence — the **.LLab Leadership Legacy Profile™** in Phase III.